

you can compensate for anything that is lacking until experience fills it in. At this point, forget about a "job." Concentrate on what you can give that the other fellow wants. The Golden Rule will help you.

Present yourself and your qualifications to the person who can give you the job. And this is where we stood a moment ago, when we decided to step back and gain perspective. Knowing the job you want, preparing to get it and getting it are not separated processes—but they repay a broad, honest view, each in turn, and when they are backed by enthusiasm they overcome obstacles that stop other men.

Are you enthusiastic about yourself? Enthusiasm flows contagiously from one mind to another, and that is how we generally see it in action. Still—have you tried being enthusiastic about yourself? *With something behind it?*

It can be a good deal of fun, and very instructive, to take that step back from *yourself*, as though stepping out of your own skin, and then look at the person who bears your name.

When you can feel enthusiastic about that fellow—fine! Even if your enthusiasm is based only on his evident *promise*, his *belief*, his *willingness*—even if not much in the way of achievement has yet shown itself—fine! Tune in on his spirit. Weigh his qualities of *giving*. Observe how well he succeeds in doing justice to the powers God gave him. When you see he is a person you can appreciate—give him a cheer!

If you hear him making excuses for himself, shake your finger at him. Tell him that life reflects back the image we show to life. You cannot hold a mirror responsible for the image it reflects.

Does he understand? Does he see that *he* is the master of his fate?

Fine! Give him a cheer!

How about it?

Success requires no explanations. Failure permits no alibis.

CHECKING ON CHAPTER 15:

Enthusiasm and action

Enthusiasm transmits the impetus toward agreement and action, whether you sell a product, a service, or yourself. An enthusiastic letter caused big men to take time to do a favor, when the same words said without enthusiasm got no